

Parts of a circle

A circle can be measured and divided in various ways. Each of these has a specific name and character, and they are all shown below.



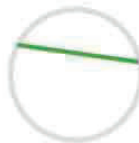
Radius

Any straight line from the center of a circle to its circumference. The plural of radius is radii.



Diameter

Any straight line that passes through the center from one side of a circle to the other.



Chord

Any straight line linking two points on a circle's circumference, but not passing through its center.



Segment

The smaller of the two parts of a circle created when divided by a chord.



Circumference

The total length of the outside edge (perimeter) of a circle.



Arc

Any section of the circumference of a circle.



Sector

A "slice" of a circle, similar to the slice of a pie. It is enclosed by two radii and an arc.



Area

The amount of space inside a circle's circumference.

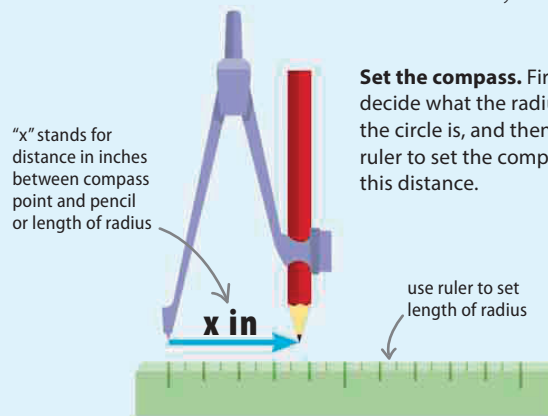


Tangent

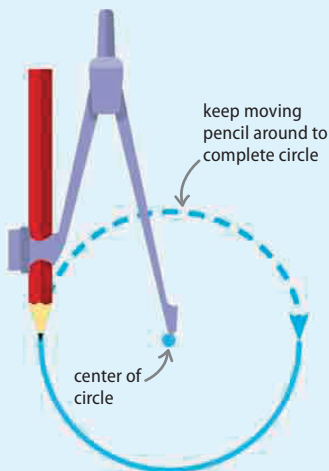
A straight line that touches the circle at a single point.

How to draw a circle

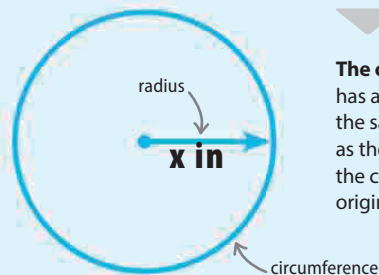
Two instruments are needed to draw a circle—a compass and a pencil. The point of the compass marks the center of the circle and the distance between the point and the pencil attached to the compass forms the circle's radius. A ruler is needed to measure the radius of the circle correctly.



Set the compass. First, decide what the radius of the circle is, and then use a ruler to set the compass at this distance.



Decide where the center of the circle is and then hold the point of the compass firmly in this place. Then put the pencil on the paper and move the pencil around to draw the circumference of the circle.



The completed circle has a radius that is the same length as the distance that the compass was originally set to.